

**Never Underestimate the Size and Speed of an Approaching Tractor-trailer**

Because of its large size, a tractor-trailer often appears to be traveling at a slower speed than it is. A substantial number of car and truck collisions take place at intersections because the driver of the car does not realize how close the truck is or how quickly it is approaching.

**Share the Road with Motorcycles**

Individuals who operate a motorcycle have the same rights and privileges as any other vehicle on the road.

For various reasons, drivers may not see the motorcyclist, and approximately one-half of all motorcycle crashes involve another vehicle. According to the National Highway Traffic Safety Administration, motorcyclists are about 35 times more likely to die in a traffic crash than passenger car occupants. A few of the most common reasons are provided below.

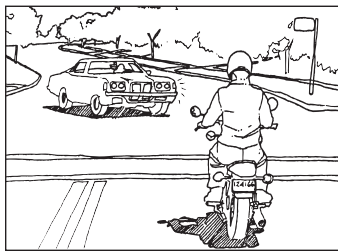
1. Many drivers tend to look for other cars, not for motorcyclists.
2. The profile of a motorcycle is much smaller than the profile of a car, making an approaching motorcyclist harder to see.
3. Estimating the distance and speed of a motorcycle is more difficult than it is for a car.
4. Motorcycle riding requires frequent lane movements to adjust to changing road conditions.
5. Distracted driving, such as texting or talking on a cell phone.

**Situations When Crashes Are Most Likely to Occur**

Motorcycle crashes are most likely to occur in the high-risk situations described below.

**Left Turns**

The most common crash between cars and motorcycles is at an intersection when the driver of a car is making a left turn in front of a motorcycle.

**A Car's Blind Spot**

Motorcyclists are often hidden in a vehicle's blind spot or missed in a quick look due to their smaller size. Always make a visual check for motorcycles by checking mirrors and blind spots before entering or leaving a lane of traffic and at intersections.

**Hazardous Road Conditions**

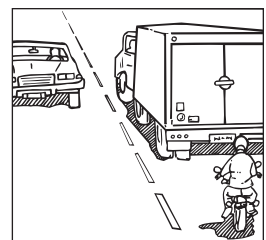
Road conditions that are a minor annoyance to you may pose a major hazard to motorcyclists. Motorcyclists may suddenly change speed or adjust their position within a lane in reaction to changes in the weather, road, or traffic conditions. This may include potholes, gravel, railroad crossings, and wet or slippery surfaces which impair the motorcyclists' braking and handling abilities. Expect and allow room for such actions by the motorcyclist.

**Strong Winds**

A strong gust of wind can move a motorcycle across an entire lane if the rider isn't prepared for it. Wind gusts from large trucks in the other lane can also be a hazard.

**Large Vehicles**

A large vehicle such as a van, bus, or truck can block a motorcycle from a driver's view and the motorcyclist may seem to suddenly appear from nowhere.

**Motorcycle Driving Awareness****Look Out for Motorcyclists**

Although you may not see any cars, be aware there may be a motorcycle. Be careful at intersections, and always take a second look for a motorcycle before turning at an intersection, particularly when making left turns.

**Signal Your Intentions**

Always signal before changing lanes or merging with traffic. This allows the motorcyclist to anticipate traffic flow and find a safe lane position. Signal even if you don't see cars or motorcycles. Be careful when making left turns across lanes of approaching traffic. Look carefully in all directions for approaching motorcyclists. Don't be fooled by a flashing turn signal. Motorcycle signals usually are not self-canceling and riders sometimes forget to turn them off. Wait to be sure the motorcycle is going to turn before you proceed.

**Respect a Motorcycle**

Allow the motorcyclist a full lane width. Although it may seem as though there is enough room in the traffic lane for an automobile and a motorcycle, the motorcycle is entitled to a full lane and may need the room to maneuver safely. Do not attempt to share the lane with a motorcycle.